Ryan Truong

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Education

Harvard University 9/2025 - Present
PhD Psychology

University of Texas at Austin 8/2021 - 12/2023
B.S. Psychology

University of Texas at Arlington 8/2020 - 5/2021
UT Coordinated Admission Program

Research Experience

CCN Lab, Harvard University 7/2024 - 2025 | 9/2025 - Present
RA / Graduate RA
PI: Sam Gershman | Supervisor(s): Lance Ying

Goris Lab, UT Austin 1/2023 - 6/2024 | 9/2024 - 5/2025
Research / Laboratory Technician
PI: Robbe Goris | Supervisor(s): Gabriela Coello-Reyes, Akash Raj

CasCogLab, UT Austin 9/2023 - 6/2024 | 9/2024 - 5/2025
Part-time RA
PI: Desmond Ong | Supervisor(s): Emma Gueorguieva, Yoon Kyung Lee

Gabrieli Lab, MIT McGovern Institute 6/2024 - 11/2024
Summer Research Intern
PI: John Gabrieli | Supervisor(s): Clark Roberts

Publications

* denotes equal contribution

Truong, R., Ying, L., Gershman, S. J., & Irie, K. (2026). PlayTrain: An Efficient Reinforcement Learning Framework for LLM-Generated Adaptable JavaScript Games. *(Submitted)*

Ying, L.*, **Truong, R.***, Tenenbaum, J. B., & Gershman, S. J. (2026). Using Theory of Mind to Arbitrate between Social and Non-social Learning. *(Submitted)*

Ying, L., **Truong, R.**, Sharma, P., Zhao, K. I., Cloos, N., Allen, K. R., Griffiths, T. L., Collins, K. M., Hernández-Orallo, J., Isola, P., Gershman, S. J., & Tenenbaum, J. B. (2026). AI Gamestore: Scalable, Open-Ended Evaluation of Machine General Intelligence with Human Games. *(NeurIPS 2026, Evaluations & Datasets Track)*

Ying, L., **Truong, R.**, Collins, K. M., Zhang, C. E., Wei, M., Brooke-Wilson, T., Zhi-Xuan, T., Wong, L., & Tenenbaum, J. B. (2025). Language-Informed Synthesis of Rational Agent Models for Grounded Theory-of-Mind Reasoning On-The-Fly. *(Findings of EMNLP, 2025)*

Ying, L.*, Hillel, A.*, **Truong, R.***, Mansinghka, V., Tenenbaum, J. B., & Zhi-Xuan, T. (2025). Belief Attribution as Mental Explanation: The Role of Accuracy, Informativity, and Causality. *(CogSci 2025)*

Ying, L., **Truong, R.**, Tenenbaum, J. B., & Gershman, S. J. (2025). Adaptive social learning using theory of mind. (*CogSci 2025*)

Mentorship & Service

Becoming a Brain Scientist (MBB S-102) 2026

Harvard Summer School

Graduate Research Mentor

- Mentored two students through summer research projects, meeting weekly and advising on the write-up of a final research paper

Health Professions Recruitment and Exposure Program (HPREP) 2025 - 2026

Harvard Medical School

Graduate Student Mentor

- Provided weekly one-on-one mentorship and guidance to high school students interested in pursuing careers in the health sciences and medicine

Graduate Student Mentorship Initiative (GSMI) 2025

Cientifico Latino

Graduate Student Mentor

- Guided prospective STEM graduate students through the application process by providing written feedback and weekly one-on-one meetings

Prospective Ph.D. & RA Event in Psychology (PPREP) 2025

Harvard Psychology Program

Graduate Student Advisor

- Advised prospective applicants navigating the Psychology PhD admissions and application process